



Updated AirPods

Apple is supposedly gearing up to launch an updated version of the AirPods later this year.
<http://dgit.in/SameOldPods>



Speech-to-text glasses

Blink while wearing the Oton Glass and it will convert whatever text you are looking at, into speech.
<http://dgit.in/OttoSpeak>



The Cold Root Model 1855

AUTOMATION

At this point, majorly due to the invention of smokeless powder, which was way more efficient, gun design was headed towards automatic loading. Up until now, a reload would require some mechanical action on the user's part – swiveling a lever; lifting, pulling, or pushing a bolt; or cocking the hammer or pulling the trigger to advance a revolver cylinder to the next chamber, etc. German manufacturers Mauser and Luger led the charge in bringing out production models that featured auto loading. In fact, Luger brought in the grip-frame mounted magazine design.



Early prototype of Mauser C96 made by Wilhelm Mauser and Paul Mauser brothers, featuring the slender oval cross-sectioned grip that earned it the nickname Broomhandle

Today's automatic firearms extend the definition a bit further by allowing rounds to be fired as long as the trigger is held down. These fully-auto firearms, compared to the single-round 'semi-automatics', are also known as machine guns. The Gatling gun with its rotating barrel design was one of the firsts.



The iconic Tommy gun that has also been called "the gun the made the 20's roar" and the "Chicago typewriter."

At this point, everyone wanted the usability of the SMGs, without compromising on the effectiveness of full machine guns. This led to the development of 'assault rifles'. Although pioneered by the Germans, it would be the Russian Kalashnikov model AK-47 that would go on to become the most widely produced military long arm design in history.



Corner Shot CSM

MODERN TIMES

Compared to pre-21st century, recent times have seen more focus on increasing the power of the handgun. While the S&W Magnum was already setting new milestones in 1935, it recently took things to a whole new level with the O.500 Magnum that surpasses the power of quite a few high power rifles at 2500 ft/lbs of muzzle energy.



Certainly the most well known of the lot, the AK47 is popular for a number of reasons



A first-generation Glock 17 with the slide locked back displaying its vertical barrel tilt

MANUAL FIREARM ACTION TYPES

- **Bolt-action:** A manual firearm action type; after rifle is fired, operating the bolt ejects an empty case and loads a fresh cartridge from the magazine
- **Lever-action:** A manual firearm action type; operating the lever ejects empty cases, moves ammunition from the magazine to the chamber, and cocks the action
- **Pump-action:** A manual firearm action type; operating the pump ejects empty cases, moves ammunition from the magazine to the chamber, and cocks the action.

In 1982, the semi-auto market was taken over by the unconventionally designed Glock, that featured a plastic-like polymer frame. While traditionalists were initially against the 'tupperware gun', today it's more likely that you'll find a Glock in a police holster in the US than any other gun.

In the last 50 years, guns have moved over to many alternative materials for a variety of reasons. Alloys and metals like scandium and titanium have been used to bring down the weight while stainless steel has been included to avoid rust in high moisture environments.

THE FUTURE OF FIREARMS

Alongside packing in a grenade launcher or shotgun capabilities, certain guns today can already fire underwater, shoot around corners, be 3D printed, folded into compact sizes, unlocked by fingerprints, adjust themselves according to the target and do a whole lot more.

Future connected guns will receive data from the base regarding targets, and in a way, 'aim themselves' – a terrifying thought! We can only hope our species eventually lets go of its bloodlust, because guns are only going to get better, and people worse...